Amanda Smith

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CURATOR, ARTIST, & ART EDUCATOR

Curatorial Specialist and Art Educator with extensive experience in exhibition development, arts administration, and visual culture education. Proven ability to lead innovative projects, conduct in-depth research, and foster community engagement through art. Skilled in curatorial practices, academic instruction, and arts journalism, with a focus on social justice and contemporary intersections of art and education.

KEY EXPERTISE & CORE ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Curatorial Practice	*Community Engagement*	*Public Programming*
Exhibition Management	*Arts Education*	*Arts Journalism*
Art & Visual Culture	*Research & Analysis*	*Museum Collaboration*

- Led the conceptual development and execution of the 'Where we go together' exhibition, integrating community narratives and innovative educational tools.
- Conducted comprehensive curatorial research and archival analysis for Ilias Lalaounis Jewelry Museum, enhancing public engagement and scholarship.
- Published over a dozen exhibition reviews and articles in Musee Magazine, contributing to contemporary arts discourse.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Curator of 'Where we go together' Exhibition **October 2025 - November 2025**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Led thematic development and audience engagement strategies for a community-focused art exhibition.

- Directed the selection and integration of student-contributed PhotoVoice data, emphasizing themes of Care, Community, and Consciousness.
- Implemented innovative educational tools such as QR code-linked surveys to enhance visitor interaction and feedback.
- Coordinated with university departments and community partners to ensure seamless project execution.

Curatorial Archive Research & Visitor Experience Assistant **July 2025 - August 2025**
Ilias Lalaounis Jewelry Museum - Athens, Greece

Supported curatorial research and public engagement initiatives at a renowned Greek jewelry museum.

- Conducted detailed research on the founder, Ilias Lalaounis, and his legacy, contributing to archival documentation.
- Enhanced visitor experience through program support and engagement strategies, increasing public interaction with collections.

Doctoral Candidate, & Graduate Associate in Art & Visual Culture Education **2025 - Present**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Supporting faculty and students in art research, curriculum development, and academic projects.

- Developed educational materials and facilitated discussions to promote inclusive learning environments.
- Assisted with classroom technology and student advising, fostering academic success and engagement.

Co-Curator of 'Teatro Delle Relazioni' **November 2023 - January 2025**
Istituto Europeo di Design - Firenze, Italy

Collaborated on a community-centered exhibition exploring social relationships and collective identity.

- Led curatorial planning and community dialogue initiatives, emphasizing social impact and inclusivity.
- Facilitated cross-cultural collaboration with Fondazione Palazzo Strozzi and local artists.

Curatorial Intern **March 2024 - August 2024**
Alfa Art Gallery

Supported curatorial and administrative functions for contemporary art exhibitions.

- Developed press materials, secured sponsorships, and contributed to exhibition research.
- Assisted with event planning, artist interviews, and interpretive content creation.

Independent Author & Creative Writer **2018 - Present**

Authored and published creative works exploring personal and societal themes.

- Published the novel 'Bittersweet Woman,' addressing trauma and healing.
- Contributed articles and reviews to Musee Magazine, engaging with contemporary art discourse.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Artist & Co-Curator of 'Rewalking Histories' **November 2025 - December 2025**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Led thematic development and audience engagement strategies for a community-focused art exhibition.

- Developed immersive listening stations and digital engagement frameworks to facilitate public dialogue regarding sensory attention and institutional memory.
- Implemented innovative educational tools such as listening stations in exhibtion to enhance visitor interaction
- Coordinated with university departments and community partners to support student led projects.

Artist & Curator of 'Material Matters: Endeavors in Arts Based Inquiry' **August 2026 - September 2026**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Organized the thematic progression of arts-based research projects within a cohort course for a participatory-focused art exhibition.

- Developed frameworks to facilitate public dialogue regarding materialism and inquiries about emerging research in art education
- Implemented innovative educational tools such as participatory stations in exhibtion to enhance visitor interaction

Curator of 'Invisible Force: Sound in Sculpture' **December 2026 - April 2027**
Sculpture Tucson - Tucson, Arizona

Curated a selection of works to support sound theories in sculpture and installation, collaborating with designers and artists

- Designed listening stations and frameworks to promote sensory attention and interaction, enhancing immersive visitor experiences.
- Implemented innovative educational tools such as listening stations in exhibtion to enhance visitor interaction

AWARDS

Graduate Student Scholar Award **June 2025**
Arizona Women's Hall of Fame - Phoenix, Arizona

Recipient of grant for doctoral research utilizing trauma-informed design to represent marginalized women's stories in museum spaces.

CSW Award for 'En·coun·ter: Designing Environments for Psychological Respite and Advocacy' **March 2026**
University of Arizona Commission on the Status of Women- Tucson, Arizona

Recipient of grant for research in trauma-informed design and modes of agency to provide student respite in high-traffic gallery spaces.

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

Presenter at SRAE Chairperson's Salon Graduate Student Research Lighting Talks **November 2024**
National Art Education Association Conferences, NAEA, Louisville, KY

Graduate Student Researcher at Lightning talks session speaking on curatorial practice for advancing education and awareness of PTSD, trauma-informed design to museums and public art in urban space.

Presenter at Emerging Conversations **November 2025- December 2026**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Annual facilitator for doctoral research expanding narratives through curatorial praxis, & trauma-informed design to represent stories of resilience in museum spaces.

Panelist, & Co-facilitator for University of Arizona, Health and Arts Community Collaboratory **October 2026**
Alliance for the Arts in Research Conferences, Ar2u, Memphis, TN

Co facilitated workshops on the ongoing curriculum collaboration with medical student programs, teaching how we thrive and flourish in our communities.

Presenter at Course: ART160d3 Museums as Cultural and Community Centers **September 2026**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Lecture and discussion session on curatorial practice within special projects, featuring the "Teatro Delle Relazioni" exhibition as a 2024 case study. The project explored community as both a way of living and a living form. The session addressed advancing visual-arts-based education, fostering communal care, collaborating, and noticing others in museum spaces.

Presenter of Course: ART150a1 Children's Art & Visual Culture **September 2026**
University of Arizona - Tucson, Arizona

Student workshop on doctoral research, "Lygia Clark: Expressions of Corporeality", A Caminhando case study. The session addressed looking at propositions for the future of education, advancing cultural visual-arts for children by participatory actions from the works of the Brazilian Artist & Art Educator.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

PhD in Art History & Visual Culture Education
University of Arizona, Tucson, Arizona, 2025 - 2027
Focusing on global art and visual culture education, research methodologies, and arts leadership.

Master in Curatorial Practice
Istituto Europeo di Design S.p.A, Firenze, Italy, November 2023-2024
Specialized in exhibition writing, curatorial insights, and contemporary art history.

Bachelor of Arts in Art & Museum Studies
Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona, 2022-2023
Honors program emphasizing global museum practices, social justice, and cultural heritage.

Associate of Arts
Eastern Gateway Community College, 2019-2022
Developed foundational skills in critical thinking, communication, and cultural awareness.

Massage Therapy Certificate
Certification, Institute for Integrative Health, 2022

Health Coaching & Hormone Balance Certification
Certification, Institute for Integrative Nutrition, 2018

SKILLS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical Skills

- Microsoft Office Suite
- Google Workspace
- Adobe Creative Cloud
- Canva
- Basic HTML & Web Publishing
- Data & Archival Research
- Multimedia Editing
- Database Management
- Spreadsheet Analysis
- Information Ethics

Publications

- Schema: World as Diagram, Musee Magazine, June 13, 2023
- Dawoud Bey: Illuminating the Power of Artistry, Musee Magazine, June 19, 2023
- Vik Muniz | Foto Cubismo, Musee Magazine, May 23, 2023
- Curtains and Towels by Katie Burnett, Musee Magazine, May 18, 2023
- Kehinde Wiley | Havana, Musee Magazine, May 17, 2023
- Gösta Peterson | Deborah Bell Photographs, Musee Magazine, April 19, 2023
- Gilbert & George, Musee Magazine, April 18, 2023
- Expo Chicago 2023, Musee Magazine, April 11, 2023
- Cary Leibowitz | Wishing Well, Musee Magazine, April 7, 2023
- Phoenix Gallery | Fashioning Self, Musee Magazine, March 31, 2023
- Michal Chelbin | Sailboats and Swans, Musee Magazine, March 30, 2023
- Urs Fischer | Ice Cream Truck Democracy, Musee Magazine, March 17, 2023
- Azuma Makoto | Frozen Flowers, Musee Magazine, March 17, 2023
- Tony Oursler | Machine E.L.F., Musee Magazine, March 6, 2023

Additional Information

- Fluent in English; Limited proficiency in Italian and French; Basic German and Greek.
- Proficient in multimedia design, web publishing, and data management.
- Committed to social justice, trauma-informed practices, and community-centered arts initiatives.